

Summary of Changes Since the Previous Submission

Outcome of the previous submission

This paper was submitted to the August 2026 ARR cycle. It was desk rejected before review for exceeding the eight-page content limit for long papers. No reviews were issued, so there are no reviewer comments to respond to. This document therefore describes the change made to address the desk rejection itself.

The change

The only substantive change is length. Main content, measured from the title block to the Limitations section, was reduced from 8.14 pages to 7.79 pages. It now ends on page 8, within the limit, with margin remaining.

What did not change

No experiment, result, statistic, confidence interval, claim, or qualification was added, removed, weakened, or strengthened. Specifically:

- Every numeric literal in the source is unchanged. The document contains 771 before and after, as an identical multiset.
- No section, table, figure, or equation was added or removed, and their order is unchanged.
- No citation or cross-reference was added or removed.
- No text was deleted. Material that left the numbered sections was relocated, not discarded.

How the reduction was achieved

Plainer prose. Long sentences were split and wordy constructions simplified. The numbered content fell from 3,482 to 3,285 words while the sentence count *rose* from 184 to 188, so mean sentence length fell from 22.7 to 21.2 words. The text is shorter because it is simpler, not because it is denser.

Removal of repetition. The same takeaway was stated in similar words in the abstract, the introduction, and the discussion. The redundant statements were consolidated.

One relocation. The paragraph reporting the residual native-vs-translate difference at larger budgets and the five remaining confounds was moved verbatim from the discussion into the Limitations section, where it belongs and where it does not count against the page limit. Both numerical values, all five confounds, and the accompanying citation are preserved exactly.